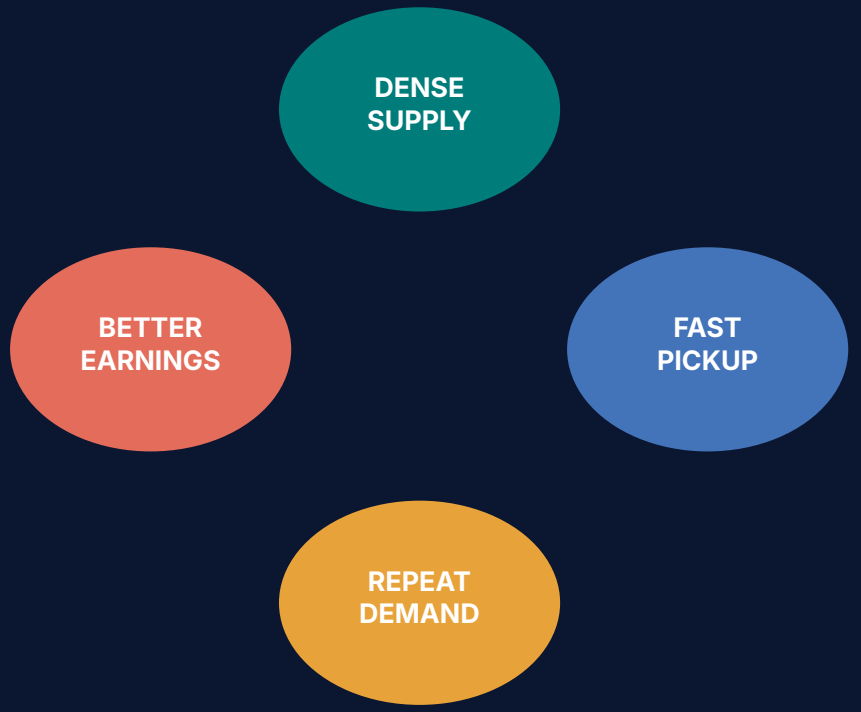
SUPERK-T KOREA

DEEP DIVE
GROWTH STRATEGY

Win the ride. Earn the fleet. Become Korea's dependable #2.

Decision discussion for the new Korea CEO
and Asia Regional Strategy Head

STRATEGY HORIZON: H2 2024–AUG 2025



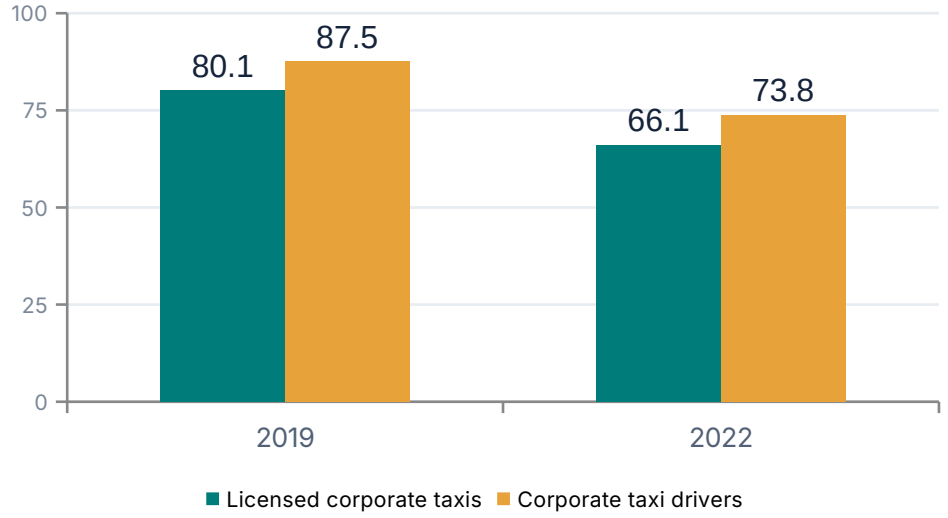
Research cut-off: 31 May 2024 | Korea

The market is valuable; the challenger is structurally small.

Kakao's network effects and a shrinking driver pool make a reliability-led, corridor-first strategy mandatory.

CORPORATE TAXI SUPPLY CONTRACTED

Licenses and working drivers, 2019 vs 2022 (000s)



2019–22: corporate fleet −17.5%; working drivers −15.7%.

Source: NABO table using National Taxi Business Association data; rounded.

₩2.5T
Taxi-call market (2023 estimate)
[1]

>10M
Taxi-call uses per month
[1]

>90%
Kakao share of call-platform market
[1]

APP SCALE GAP — DIRECTIONAL, NOT MARKET SHARE

7.6M Kakao T

0.27M legacy challenger proxy

Mar 2023 Google Play user estimates; pre-rebrand, not comparable paid-ride share. [3]

REBRAND CREATES A WEDGE—NOT A DOMESTIC MOAT

11.03M

2023 inbound visitors (63% of 2019). Rebrand lets visitors use the global app to hail a local taxi—convert this demand while fixing Korean rider reliability. [4][5]

IMPERATIVE **Seed dependable supply in selected demand cells; localize trust and pickup execution before buying broad reach.**

Build a credible #2 by winning a few dense markets first.

The winning unit is a high-performing city-cell, not national downloads or registered-driver count.

01 OWN THE FIRST CELLS

Prioritize Seoul's high-frequency corridors: Gangnam–Yeouido, Hongdae–Mapo, Jongno–Yongsan, plus airport access. Expand only when pickup reliability holds.

02 WIN ON RELIABILITY

Position around predictable pickup, transparent taxi fare, respectful service recovery, and a driver offer that feels fair—not an indefinite coupon war.

03 SEED DEMAND THAT REPEATS

Acquire local repeat riders first; use inbound visitors and business travel as efficient wedges where the rebrand has real advantage.

04 DEPLOY CAPITAL WITH GATES

Fund peak supply and conversion experiments. Stop promotions that do not create incremental rides, better retention, or more online driver-hours.

SEQUENCE THE INVESTMENT

AUG–SEP 2024

Establish

Baseline by cell; certify supply; fix Korean conversion blockers.

OCT–DEC 2024

Prove

Pilot fleet economics, peak incentives, and repeat-rider loops.

JAN–AUG 2025

Scale

Expand only proven cells; add a second city after service gates.

Expansion gate: peak match success + repeat usage + driver earnings per online hour + positive incremental contribution.

PROPOSED 12-MONTH AMBITION | Validate May–July baseline before locking targets

- **5%+** app-hail trip share in target cells
- **+50%** weekly active drivers in cells
- **+10pp** 90-day repeat rate
- **ROI-gated** all rider/driver incentives

Make the driver proposition worth switching the phone for.

The goal is incremental available hours from licensed taxis—not vanity sign-ups or permanent subsidy.

SUPPLY REALITY

−17.5%

corporate taxi licenses, 2019–22

107.8K

65+ taxi drivers in 2023, up ~30% vs. 2019; onboarding, safety, and accessible service matter as the pool ages

Sources: NABO / association; TS data via Yonhap. [2][6]

1 | CORPORATE FLEETS

Make platform value visible to operators

- Pilot 3 anchor fleets in Seoul/Gyeonggi; target 10 fleet agreements by Dec ’24.
- Offer no-exclusivity dispatch, clear terms, prompt reconciliation, and fleet-level utilization reports.
- Deploy an onboarding desk: driver setup, app training, device help, and weekly issue review.

H2 gate: 2,000 incremental weekly-active drivers

2 | INDIVIDUAL DRIVERS

Pay for availability that riders can feel

- Referral + ambassador program; no forced exclusivity or opaque ranking incentives.
- Capped 30-day fee holiday / shift guarantees only in under-supplied peak cells.
- Show expected net earnings, trip details, and the reason for a dispatch outcome; enable appeal.

Pilot: peak acceptance +8pp vs. matched control

3 | UTILIZATION

Turn supply into dependable coverage

- Forecast 30-minute demand by cell; stage voluntary airport, station, and nightlife coverage.
- Use targeted bonuses for completed peak trips, not logged-in time or low-quality volume.
- Track multi-app overlap, acceptance, cancellations, driver earnings/hour, and active hours.

Aug ’25 target: +50% weekly actives in launch cells

Localize the ride—not only the copy.

Use segments where the rebrand helps acquisition, then earn domestic repeat through frictionless pickup and payment.

LOCAL REPEAT RIDERS — **Workday + late-night**

Build habit with dependable pickup in core corridors. Run referral and first-ride offers only where incremental conversion is measurable.

Channels: search, employer benefits, local merchants

BUSINESS + SMES — **Work trips that need receipts**

Create business profiles, itemized receipts, centralized billing, booked rides where lawful, and a service recovery promise.

Channels: employer pilots, hotels, travel managers

INBOUND VISITORS — **Global account, local certainty**

Use global-app familiarity, international payment, multilingual help, airport curb guidance, and landmark-based pickup.

Channels: hotels, OTAs, tourism partners, airports

KOREAN CONVERSION BACKLOG — FIX IN THIS ORDER

01 OPEN + SIGN IN

Korean-first copy, domestic account flow, and a low-friction path for users without a Korean number.

02 FIND THE PICKUP

Korean address/POI search, building and subway-exit landmarks, pin correction, airport curb instructions.

03 MATCH + MEET

Accurate ETA, license plate / vehicle confirmation, pickup chat, clear cancellation rules, Korean support.

04 PAY + RETURN

Local-card / wallet coverage, automatic receipt, trip issue resolution, one-tap rebooking and repeat offer.

Measure by cohort: app-open → request conversion | request → accepted | accepted → completed | 30/90-day repeat | complaint rate

Operate inside taxi rules; make compliance visible in the product.

In Korea, safe growth depends on licensed supply, city-specific fare rules, and disciplined use of location data.

NON-NEGOTIABLE GO-LIVE CONTROLS

A — Vehicle + platform scope

Match only verified, licensed taxis with required insurance. Counsel to confirm whether each feature is brokerage, franchise, or platform transport—and required permits/filings under the Passenger Transport Service Act.

B — Meter + fare integrity

Honor municipal taxi meters and allowed surcharges. Keep platform-funded coupons / driver bonuses separate from regulated fare logic; show the fare basis before request.

C — Location + personal data

Confirm location-business registration/reporting, consent and purpose limits, retention schedule, access logs, processor controls, and a tested incident response.

D — Fair dispatch + safety

Publish driver-facing dispatch and cancellation rules; provide appeal and complaint routes; verify driver qualification, vehicle, and trip safety escalation.

H2 2024 POLICY WATCH

HIGH IMPACT

Corporate taxi wage system

Nationwide expansion was scheduled for Aug ’24. On 9 May, taxi labor and management urged amendment, citing viability and driver-supply risk. Scenario-plan with fleets; do not assume the rule changes or disappears.

OPERATING RESPONSE

- Regulatory owner + counsel sign-off before every new city or feature.
- Monthly check-in with taxi associations, fleet operators, and city transport teams.
- CEO launch gate: license classification, fare, data, safety, and labor-impact checklist complete.

Sources: Passenger Transport Service Act; KCC location-data inspection; May 2024 wage-system debate. [1][8][9]

Build a durable advantage in earnings, emissions, and service quality.

Innovation should strengthen the taxi marketplace first; scale new modes only after reliability and economics clear gates.

THE LOCAL MARKETPLACE FLYWHEEL



North-star measures

Pickup reliability • driver net earnings / online hour • 90-day repeat • empty km / completed trip

THREE HORIZONS

2024 | FIX THE CORE — **Dispatch + safety quality**

Improve pickup-point accuracy, ETA calibration, cancellation recovery, in-trip safety response, and Korean customer support.

2025 | GREEN FLEET PILOT — **Lower-cost, lower-emission supply**

Pilot 1–2 fleet partners on EV / hybrid taxi economics: lease or financing access, charging support, maintenance, and driver utilization reporting.

2026+ | PERMITTED OPTIONS — **Accessible + advanced mobility**

Test accessible and scheduled services with licensed operators. Explore autonomous taxi pilots only through approved programs; no standalone fleet capex until law and unit economics are clear.

Investment rule: no future-mode scale until peak service, driver economics, and compliance are green.

DISCUSSION

Q&A

Decision points for the CEO × Asia Strategy discussion

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01 **Approve Seoul density-first as the primary growth thesis for H2 2024?**

02 **Fund a capped driver + Korean UX pilot with explicit scale / stop gates?**

03 **Confirm the legal red-lines, regulatory owner, and location-data controls?**

Proposed outcome: approve the H2 launch thesis, release a gated pilot budget, and review the first operating scorecard in October 2024.

H2 2024 delivery plan and investment gates.

Start with a July baseline, activate changes from August, and release scale capital only against measured outcomes.

WHEN	DELIVERABLES	ACCOUNTABLE	GATE / OUTPUT
JUN–JUL 2024	Baseline trips, cell-level demand/supply map, Korean UX funnel, legal classification, driver economics, fleet pipeline.	Strategy + Ops + Legal	Baseline & legal sign-off
AUG–SEP 2024	Launch 4–6 Seoul cells; 3 fleet pilots; driver concierge; localized pickup, payment, and customer support fixes.	City Ops + Product	Daily reliability war-room
OCT–NOV 2024	Test capped peak incentives; business / hotel distribution; cohort-level repeat and cancellation experiments.	Growth + Supply	Stop / scale by control test
DEC 2024–JAN 2025	Protect year-end coverage; shift budgets to cells where driver earnings, pickup, repeat, and incremental contribution improve.	GM + Finance	Investment gate review
FEB–AUG 2025	Expand only proven Seoul cells; add one metro/city after service, economics, and regulator gates clear.	CEO + Strategy	5%+ trip-share ambition

Explicit guardrail: do not widen geography, discount, or add a vehicle mode until supply, repeat, and contribution gates pass.

Sources, date discipline, and interpretation notes.

All market facts are limited to information publicly available on or before 31 May 2024; later outcomes are excluded.

[1] KCC | 27 Nov 2023
Taxi-call market ~₩2.5T; >10M calls/month; Kakao >90% share; location-data inspections.

Open source ↗

[2] NABO | 2023 report
Taxi registrations and driver counts, 2019–22; tables source National Taxi Business Association.

Open source ↗

[3] Asia Business Daily | 13 Apr 2023
Mobile Index Google Play users: Kakao T 7.6M; Wooty 270K; Tada 50K; i'm 40K (directional proxy).

Open source ↗

[4] Yonhap | 29 Feb 2024
Rebrand to Uber Taxi; international visitors may use the global app in Korea.

Open source ↗

[5] Yonhap / KTO | 30 Jan 2024
2023 inbound tourists: 11.03M, 63% of 2019 level.

Open source ↗

[6] Asia Business Daily / TS | 16 Feb 2024
Taxi drivers aged 65+: ~107.8K in 2023 vs. 82.9K in 2019 (+30%).

Open source ↗

[7] KCI | 2023 law review
Kakao T driver subscription rate 92.8% (220K/240K), Aug 2021; historical penetration indicator.

Open source ↗

[8] Korean Law | 2023 version
Passenger Transport Service Act: platform transport, franchise, and brokerage categories.

Open source ↗

[9] Asia Business Daily | 9 May 2024
Nationwide taxi monthly-wage system scheduled for Aug 2024; labor/management sought amendment.

Open source ↗

CAVEATS

SuperK-T internal share, contribution, driver counts, and satisfaction data were not provided. Challenger app-user data are pre-rebrand Google Play estimates, not market share or completed trips. Proposed growth targets are management ambitions; validate denominators and baseline in June–July 2024.